

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Ex-CEO at ComEd sentenced in bribery

Pramaggiore gets 2 years in scheme tied to Madigan

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Once a rising corporate star, former ComEd CEO Anne Pramaggiore was sentenced Monday to two years in federal prison for her role in an elaborate scheme to funnel more than \$1.3 million and other perks to associates of then-House Speaker Michael Madigan in exchange for help with the utility's ambitious legislative agenda.

In handing down the sentence, U.S. District Judge Manish Shah acknowledged Pramaggiore's transformative leadership at ComEd and her history of charitable works, but said the evidence at trial showed she also participated in a nearly decade-long scheme that undermined the public's trust in government.

"This was secretive sophisticated criminal corruption of important public policy," Shah said. "When it came to Mr. Madigan ... you didn't think to change the culture of corruption. Instead you were all in."

Shah said the dichotomy in Pramaggiore's life led him to "conclude that people like you, good people in positions of power and authority, need to be deterred too."

"You had the power to stop this," the judge said. "You could have said 'No, this is not how legislation should be done.' You had the power to change the culture at ComEd."

He also found that she had lied repeatedly during her testimony at trial, particularly in denying knowledge of the connection of ComEd's no-work subcontractors to the powerful Democratic speaker and telling the jury she made no effort to cover it up.

Pramaggiore, who turns 67 in two weeks, showed little outward reaction as Shah announced his sentence, which also included a \$750,000 fine.

A few minutes earlier, Pramaggiore had been given the chance to address the judge but declined to do so. "Thank you, your honor. I will stand on my able attorney's commentary and submissions," she said while remaining seated at the defense table.

Shah ordered Pramaggiore to report to prison by Dec. 1. However her attorney, Scott

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Dangerous heat expected this week

Dangerously high temperatures and humidity are forecast for Wednesday and Thursday, with the National Weather Service issuing an extreme heat watch. **Chicagoland, Page 3**



CHRIS PIZZELLO/AP FILE

Malcolm-Jamal Warner dies

Malcolm-Jamal Warner, who played teenage son Theo Huxtable on "The Cosby Show," dies in an accidental drowning in Costa Rica. He was 54. **Page 9**



Parents Rocio Lasso and Rodrigo Vásquez and Milena Estepa de Vásquez, the widow of Chicago police Officer Andrés Vásquez Lasso, stand Monday after the guilty verdict against Steven Montano for first-degree murder and other felonies in the March 2023 slaying of the 32-year-old officer.

E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Man found guilty in '23 shooting death of officer

State's attorney decries 'senseless act of violence' in slaying of Vásquez Lasso

By Madeline Buckley
Chicago Tribune

A Cook County jury on Monday convicted a man of first-degree murder in the fatal shooting of Chicago police Officer Andrés Vásquez Lasso following a weeklong trial marked by difficult body camera

footage of the 2023 slaying.

Despite a long shot bid for the lesser offense of second-degree murder, the jury convicted Steven Montano, 21, of the more serious charge, finding no mitigating circumstances to the shooting after deliberating for less than two hours.

The jury also found Montano

guilty of a felony gun offense.

"We all were reminded today what a dangerous job a police officer has," State's Attorney Eileen O'Neill Burke said after the verdict. "(Vásquez Lasso) was killed in a senseless act of violence as he was running toward danger."

Family members embraced after the verdict but did not wish to speak. Police union officials said Vásquez Lasso was living a "dream that got cut short" after immigrating to the United States

from Colombia.

"We lost an officer. They lost a family member. We lost a family member," Chicago police Superintendent Larry Snelling said, speaking after the verdict.

Few facts of the shooting were in dispute, as attorneys instead in their final arguments sought to probe the mind of Montano after Cook County Judge John Lyke Jr. found — in a win for the defense

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More than 200 Chicago Police Department members during a promotion and graduation ceremony at Navy Pier on Aug. 28, 2023. E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

CPD brass accused mayor's budget office of slowing down paychecks

Johnson's office said snafu over forms was 'administrative error'

By Alice Yin
Chicago Tribune

Chicago Police Department brass accused Mayor Brandon Johnson's administration of deliberately slowing down paychecks for dozens of employees this summer in a fiery email that warned the city was jeopardizing its compliance with the federal consent decree.

Police Department Deputy Director Ryan Fitzsimons emailed multiple officials in Johnson's budget office June 2 to alert them of the department's overdue A-forms, paperwork required to process paychecks for new hires and promotions. After following up the next day to confirm that police recruits were not getting their first paychecks, he sent an additional message June 10 saying Johnson's budget office was purposely sitting on the forms.

"Given that we discussed

at length via email and on our meeting on May 8th the need for timely approval of A-Forms, it would appear that OBM is pursuing a pattern of practice to delay the approval of A-Forms with the functional result of not paying employees on time and delaying compliance with the Consent Decree," Fitzsimons wrote. "What is OBM's plan to systematically approve or deny A-forms?"

The unusually contentious email noted, "CPD is commit-

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ANALYSIS

President patches fracture in base

Ire over Epstein files redirected as backers rally to Trump's side

By Erica L. Green
The New York Times

WASHINGTON — In the week after the Justice Department walked back its promise to release the full collection of files about disgraced financier and convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, it seemed there was nothing President Donald Trump could do to quell the fury of some of his supporters.

He tried to coax them as he defended his attorney general against their wrath, asking "What's going on with my 'boys' and, in some cases, 'gals'?" He said he did not understand their interest in the case, downplaying it as "boring."

He even castigated them as "weaklings" and disavowed them as "PAST supporters." Still, the backlash kept building.

But when The Wall Street Journal published a story detailing a decades-old letter with a lewd drawing that Trump allegedly sent Epstein for his birthday, Trump got a respite from the revolt, as some of his core supporters rushed to his

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